Indian Institute of Management Calcutta

Programme **: MBA**

Name of the Course: **EC-PP-266 Global Political Economy of the 21st Century**

Core / Elective: **ELECTIVE**

Credit: **3 CREDITS** Cap (for Elective): **75 STUDENTS**

Academic Year & Term**: 2026-27. TERM VI (ONE SECTION)**

Course Coordinator: **PROFESSOR BIJU PAUL ABRAHAM, PUBLIC POLICY & MANAGEMENT GROUP**

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Instructor: PROFESSOR BIJU PAUL ABRAHAM Sessions: 9)

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Instructor: PROFESSOR Partha Ray (Sessions: 11)

Affiliation: Director, National Institute of Bank Management Pune and Former Faculty, Economics Group, IIM Calcutta.

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Introduction to Course /Course Description

The course will discuss the context of contemporary global economic and political changes in different regions / countries of the world that are of current concern as a background to business. Its special emphasis will be on the political economy of the following countries / group of countries: the US, major economies in EU and the Euro Area, Asian economies like China, Japan, India, Singapore, Korea or Vietnam, economies in Middle East and North Africa. It will also discussion related topics such as the geopolitics of energy and of Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Course Objective and Key-takeaways from the course

Expose students to current global economic developments, especially in the context of the recent trade wars and the Ukraine, Gaza and other regional crises and relate it to changes in the regional and global political environment so that they gain a better perspective of the implications of these issues to the global, regional and national business environment.

Programme Level Learning Goals (7)

1. Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organisational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations
2. Develop a global perspective that is built upon knowledge of economic, technological, regulatory and political forces that are shaping a new international order in the 21st century.
3. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same

International Components in your course (if any)

Most of the sessions focus on international political and economic affairs.

Pre-requisites: None

Required Text Book(s):

Robert O. Brian and Marc Williams, *Global Political Economy: Evolution and Dynamics* (7th Edition), (Macmillan, 2024).

Recommended Text Book(s):

Course Pack Distribution to students

Additional Readings will be provided for the course on the CourseWeb.

Technology enabled learning component for your course

None.

Session Plan

(Readings and Cases indicated for each session are in the Course Handout and also uploaded on the Course Web)

Session/ Instructor	Topic	Session Details
1: BPA & PR*	Introduction	Introduction to Global Political Economy
2: PR	The Global Economy in the time of Trade War	Discussion of the long-term trends in globalization and the impact of Covid-19 pandemic on the global economy – emergence of inflation and its reduction – possibility of a global recession.
3: PR	The US Economy in the 21st Century	Sub-Prime crisis and the Great Recession – Fiscal and Monetary Stimulus – Recent Trade War –Withdrawal of US monetary expansion - How is the US economy doing?
4 BPA	The Changing Global Role of the US	The US in the post-Cold War world – US Alliances in Europe and Asia and its role in global stability – the Trump Administration and trade war – future of US-China relations – US-Russia relations in the context of the Ukraine Crisis
5: PR	Euro-Area Crisis	Tragedy of an optimum currency area (Mundell's Model) - the Euro-area crisis with special reference to the Greek economy – Current Monetary Policy Dilemmas of Europe.
6: BPA	The Crisis in the European Union & Brexit	The impact of the EU on global and regional politics; Brexit and its impact on the EU and the UK; Challenges in a post-Covid world; EU's role in the Ukraine conflict; EU Russia relations
7: PR	Other Major European Economies – UK, Germany, France	Brexit – Growth Deceleration in France and Germany – Pandemic-related Economic Stimulus – The crisis in UK and the future of the British economy.
8: PR	Asia: Emergence of China	Emergence of China as an industrial superpower – global imbalance - Chinese Currency Misalignment as a strategy of trade policy - Recent growth deceleration in China - – The Sino-US Trade War — Deceleration in China.
9: PR	Sobering of the Japanese Economy	Long-term stagnation in the Japanese economy – bursting of asset price bubble – emergence of quantitative easing – the demographic crisis – Abenomics & Post-Abe Japan
10: PR	Russia and the CIS Economies	Russia and the CIS Economies - The Economic Impact of the Rusia- Ukraine War
11: BPA	China – The Rise of a New Great Power	The 're-emergence' of China and its impact on global politics/institutions - China's Security Concerns; deterioration of China-US relations and its impact on stability in Asia – China-Taiwan relations

Session/ Instructor	Topic	Session Details
12: BPA	Japan and its neighbors	Japan's security and demographic concerns; Constitutional changes in Japan and its potential impact on Japan's regional and global role; Sino-Japanese and Japanese Korean Relations – Post-Abe: Shape of things to come
13: BPA	Russia and the Second Cold War	The origins of the Ukraine crisis; Russia-Ukraine war; implications of NATO expansion on Russia and regional stability
14: BPA	Politics of the Middle East and North Africa (MENA)	Oil and Geopolitics in the Middle East and North Africa (MENA); The impact of religious conflict on Arab and Gulf geopolitics; The Arab-Israeli dispute; Saudi Arabia; Syria; Iran
15: BPA	India and its Neighbours	India in South Asia; relations with Pakistan and China; India's relations with the US, Russia and South East Asia.
16: PR	Middle East and Oil Prices	Middle East Economies - Exchange rate arrangement among GCC countries- Economics of Oil Price and its roller-coaster movements – Resource Curse – Pandemic and the GCC countries
17: BPA	New Nationalism	Growth of far-right and far left parties in the US and Europe; growth of nationalist parties in Asia and their impact
18: PR	India's Neighbours - 2	Pakistan, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh
19: PR	Asia: Emergence of India	Broad Trends in the Indian Economy - India's emergence as a growth pole – impact of the trade war on India –
20: BPA & PR	Summing up	The Trade War, Political Economy of AI and the technology war, international conflicts, regional tensions and their longer-term impact on the international business environment.

BPA: Biju Paul Abraham PR: Partha Ray

Evaluation Components

Mid-Term Exam : 50%
End Term Exam : 50%